

Week 5 講義 : Brawl Stars: The Turning Point

文法重點：現在進行式 (am / is / are + V-ing : 肯定句、否定句、疑問句與動詞變化規則)

發音特訓：台灣人最常犯的 4 大發音陷阱 (尾音煞車、Dark L 舌尖頂顎、TH 咬舌、輕重音與弱化母音)

核心單字：12 個 (教育部 800 進階常用字・難度全面升級)

Part 1 : Reading - Brawl Stars: The Turning Point

Supercell is a famous mobile game company in Finland. They **develop** world-famous games like *Clash of Clans* and *Hay Day*. Supercell has a special rule: if a new game does not become a huge hit, they kill it. They even celebrate with a party when they **cancel** a project! Most ideas at the company fail because their quality standards are so high.

In 2017, a small Supercell team wanted to create a **unique** action shooter for phones. The early project was called *Project Laser*. Later, it became *Brawl Stars*. In June 2017, the team released the game in Canada to test player reactions.

At first, *Brawl Stars* had a tall, vertical screen (portrait mode). Players held their phone with one hand and tapped the screen to move and shoot. The characters were fun and colorful, but the team faced a big crisis: after playing for three or four days, many players stopped opening the game. Every week, player numbers continued to **decrease** fast.

The game was in serious danger. Supercell managers put heavy **pressure** on the team: if the game could not keep players, the company would cancel *Brawl Stars* forever.

The developers had many long meetings filled with fear and **doubt**. Some people wanted to make only small changes to the numbers. But team lead Ryan knew small changes would fail. Ryan later told players: "It was not a choice between a vertical screen or a horizontal screen. It was horizontal screen or kill the game."

So the developers made a bold move. They turned the phone sideways and built a brand-new control **system**. On this wide screen, they placed two control circles for the thumbs. With the left thumb, players controlled movement in every direction. With the right thumb, players aimed and shot at enemies.

When the update arrived, early players shared harsh **opinions**. Many old players began to **complain** angrily on online forums: "This update is terrible! You will ruin our favorite game! Change it back!" The early response was mostly **negative**.

However, the team believed in their new **system**. Soon, a wave of new players arrived. These new players gave warm, **positive** reviews. They loved the wide view and the natural two-thumb controls. Players stayed in the game much longer, and player numbers went up every day.

Against all odds, the game **survived** Supercell's strict test. On December 12, 2018, *Brawl Stars* finally launched to the whole world. Today, more than one hundred million people battle together every month!

Part 2 : Core Vocabulary 核心單字 (800 級進階實用字)

#	Word	POS	中文意思	Simple Example
1	develop	v.	開發；研發	Supercell engineers develop fun mobile games.
2	unique	adj.	獨特的；與眾不同的	Each brawler in the game has a unique skill.
3	decrease	v. / n.	減少；下降	Player numbers decrease when a game is boring.

#	Word	POS	中文意思	Simple Example
4	pressure	n.	壓力	The team worked under heavy pressure to save the game.
5	cancel	v.	取消；終止（專案）	The company will cancel the project if it fails.
6	doubt	n. / v.	懷疑；疑慮	The team had doubt, but they still tried their best.
7	system	n.	系統；機制	The new control system uses two thumbs.
8	opinion	n.	意見；看法	What is your opinion on the new game update?
9	complain	v.	抱怨；抗議	Old players complain when the controls change.
10	negative	adj.	負面的；消極的	The early forum comments were very negative.
11	positive	adj.	正面的；積極的	Good updates bring positive reviews from players.
12	survive	v.	存活；挺過（危機）	The game survived the crisis and became popular.

Part 3 : CAP-style Reading Comprehension

- What is the main idea of the story?
 - Supercell makes more money from *Hay Day* than from action shooters.
 - A brave decision to overhaul the control system helped *Brawl Stars* survive and succeed.
 - Canadian gamers always write negative opinions about mobile games.
 - Game developers should cancel projects as soon as players complain.
- Why was *Brawl Stars* in serious danger during the 2017 soft launch in Canada?
 - The characters were too scary for young children.
 - The game was too expensive to download on phones.
 - Active player numbers continued to decrease after just a few days.
 - The phones could not connect to the Internet in Finland.
- Why did Supercell managers put heavy **pressure** on the team?
 - They wanted the team to develop a game for computers instead of phones.
 - The game was not keeping enough players, so it was close to being cancelled.
 - The team members refused to hold meetings in the morning.
 - Players in Canada complained about the game's colorful graphics.
- What did Ryan mean when he said, "*It was horizontal screen or kill the game*"?
 - The developers planned to kill players who liked horizontal screens.
 - Turning to a horizontal screen was the only possible way for the game to survive.
 - Horizontal phones were cheaper to buy in Finland.
 - Supercell wanted to stop developing mobile games completely.
- How did early players react when the team first released the horizontal update?
 - They shared negative opinions and began to complain angrily on forums.
 - They sent positive letters and celebrated with a party.
 - They asked the company to cancel all future Supercell games.
 - They stopped using thumbs to play mobile games.
- Which word has the closest meaning to "**survived**" in the last paragraph?
 - Made a lot of money.
 - Stayed alive through danger.
 - Changed back to vertical mode.
 - Cancelled all player accounts.

7. What important lesson can game creators learn from the *Brawl Stars* team?
- A. Never make any big changes when a project is in trouble.
 - B. Always cancel a project if old players complain about an update.
 - C. Bold changes and a better user system can turn negative crises into positive success.
 - D. Vertical one-hand controls are always better than two-thumb controls.

Part 4 : Taiwanese Pronunciation Clinic 台灣人最常犯的 4 大發音陷阱

很多台灣同學英文單字背很多，但開口發音總被外國人說「聽起來怪怪的」。這不是因為你英文不好，而是因為國語的發音肌肉習慣在不知不覺中「帶壞」了你的英文！以下整理 4 大台灣人最常踩到的發音雷區，用我們學過的單字一次校準：

Trap 1: 尾音偷加「呃」病 (Stop Sound 氣音急煞車)

病因分析： 中文國語每個字尾巴幾乎都是母音 (ㄚ、ㄜ、ㄛ)，所以台灣學生遇到以無聲子音 /t/ , /k/ , /p/ , /d/ 結尾的單字時，喉嚨會忍不住「多送一口氣」，唸成「project-呃」、「doubt-呃」！

矯正秘訣： 嘴型到位立刻「急煞車」！舌尖或嘴唇碰到位置就鎖住氣流，絕對不能吐出任何「呃」的聲音。

單字	台灣人常見盲點 ✖	正確美式發音技巧 ✔	肌肉動作與口訣
doubt (W5)	doub-ter (把 b 唸出來或加呃)	/daʊt/	b 不發音 (silent b) ！結尾 t 舌尖頂上牙齦立刻閉氣煞車！
project (W2)	pro-jec-ter (加「特/呃」)	/'prɑ:dʒekt/	字尾 t 舌尖抵住上牙齦立刻閉氣，不送氣。
respect (W4)	res-pec-ter	/rɪ'spekt/	停在 t 的阻氣點，不放氣。
shoot (日常)	shoo-ter	/ʃu:t/	嘴唇微噉發 oo ，舌尖一頂上牙齦瞬間收住！
unique (W5)	u-ni-kwe (看字亂拼)	/ju'ni:k/	唸成 you-NEEK ，重音在後，字尾 k 喉嚨瞬間煞車！

Trap 2: 字尾 L (Dark L) 唸成「歐」或「控肉」(舌尖頂上牙齦)

病因分析： 國語沒有字尾 /l/ 音，大家常常偷懶把字尾的 -l 或 -le 唸成注音的「ㄌ」或「ㄛ」，甚至把 control 唸成「控肉」！

矯正秘訣： 字尾發 Dark L 時，舌尖一定要從嘴底升起，緊緊頂在「上排門牙後方的牙齦肉」上！聲音在喉嚨與舌頭深處產生共鳴，嘴唇保持放鬆、不要噉成圓圈！

單字	台灣人常見盲點 ✖	正確美式發音技巧 ✔	肌肉動作與口訣
control (W4)	con-trow (控肉)	/kən'troul/	唸到結尾時，舌尖務必往上頂住門牙後方！
cancel (W5)	can-so (看瘦)	/'kænsəl/	字尾 -el 舌尖上頂，發出厚實的 /l/ 音。
skill (W3)	ski-o (死基歐)	/skɪl/	不是「歐」，舌尖頂上去才是真正的 skill ！
fail (日常)	fei-o (飛歐)	/feɪl/	結尾舌尖頂顎，聲音厚實不飄浮。

Trap 3: TH 音偷懶唸成 S 或 D，以及 V 與 W 混淆

病因分析：國語沒有「咬舌音」，很多人偷懶把 /θ/ 唸成 S，把 /ð/ 唸成 D。此外，國語沒有唇齒音 /v/，很多人把 survive 唸成「瑟歪五」（把 v 唸成 w）！

矯正秘訣：TH 咬舌尖；V 要上門牙咬下嘴唇！

單字	台灣人常見盲點 ❌	正確美式發音技巧 ✅	肌肉動作與口訣
they / them / their (W4)	day / dem / dare	/ðeɪ/, /ðem/, /ðer/	上下牙齒輕輕咬住舌尖，聲帶震動發出摩擦感！
survive (W5)	sur-why-ve (把 v 唸成 w)	/sər'vaɪv/	兩個 v 上門牙都要輕咬下嘴唇內側，聲帶震動！
strength (W3)	stren-s / stren-t	/streŋkθ/	字尾咬住舌尖吐氣，不是發注音「ㄣ」！

Trap 4: 輕重音與弱化母音 /ə/ (英文是重音節拍，不是國語叮叮叮)

病因分析：國語是「音節等長」語言（每個字節拍一樣長：叮-叮-叮）。但英文是「重音節拍」語言：重音音節要「長、大、高」，非重音音節要「短、小、快」，非重音母音常會縮成模糊的 /ə/ (schwa)。

單字	台灣人常見盲點 ❌	正確美式發音技巧 ✅	節拍與音量對比
develop (W5)	DE-ve-lop (重音在前)	/dɪ'veləp/	重音在中間 -ve- (短-大-短)！
opinion (W5)	O-pi-nion (第一音大聲)	/ə'pɪnjən/	第一個 o 弱化成 /ə/ (額)，重音在 -pi-！
negative (W5)	ne-GA-tive	/'negətɪv/	重音在最前面 neg-，後面 -ative 輕快帶過！
positive (W5)	po-SI-tive	/'pɑːzətɪv/	重音在最前面 pos-！

🎧 課堂 60 秒肌肉記憶挑戰 (Muscle Memory Challenge)

請看著老師，用「煞車」、「舌尖上頂」、「咬舌頭」、「咬下唇」四招，一口氣精準唸出這 6 個進階單字：

- ☐ 1. doubt (b 不發音，字尾 t 急煞車)
- ☐ 2. unique (you-NEEK，重音在後，結尾 k 煞車)
- ☐ 3. survive (兩次門牙輕咬下嘴唇，聲帶震動)
- ☐ 4. develop (重音在第二音節：de-VEL-op)
- ☐ 5. opinion (首音節弱化成 /ə/：uh-PIN-yun)
- ☐ 6. cancel (字尾 Dark L 舌尖緊貼上牙齦)

Part 5 : Grammar - Present Continuous 現在進行式

1. 什麼時候用？(Trigger 觸發雷達)

現在進行式用來描述**「說話當下正在發生、正在進行的動作」，或者「此時此刻正在發生的變化趨勢」**。

常見時間關鍵字 (雷達信號)：

- now (現在), right now (此時此刻), at the moment (此刻)
- 現場驚嘆呼叫：Look! (你看!), Listen! (你聽!), Be quiet! (安靜!)

2. 句型公式骨架 (Pattern)

句型	公式結構	例句
肯定句	主詞 + am / is / are + V-ing	The engineers are developing a new system right now.
否定句	主詞 + am / is / are + not + V-ing	The team is not cancelling the project at this moment.
Yes/No 問句	Am / Is / Are + 主詞 + V-ing?	Are players complaining about the new update?
Wh- 疑問句	疑問詞 + is / are + 主詞 + V-ing?	Why is the player number decreasing this week?

口訣：有 be 才有 ing，兩者缺一不可！

3. V-ing 動詞字尾變化 3 大規則

規則	說明	原形動詞	V-ing 形式
規則 1：直接加 -ing	大多數動詞直接加 ing	develop, complain, turn	developing, complaining, turning
規則 2：去 e 加 -ing	字尾是「不發音的 e」時，去掉 e 再加 ing	survive, decrease, change	surviving, decreasing, changing
規則 3：雙寫字尾加 -ing	「單一短母音 + 單子音」結尾，雙寫最後子音再加 ing	run, stop, win, sit	running, stopping, winning, sitting

(注意：shoot 中間有兩個母音 oo，不是單一短母音，所以直接加 ing：shooting！)

4. 三大失分致命陷阱 (Traps)

- **✗ 陷阱 1：忘了 be 動詞 (無照駕駛)**
 - 錯誤：The developers working under pressure.
 - 正確：The developers **are** working under pressure. (一定要有 am/is/are!)
- **✗ 陷阱 2：be 動詞與原形動詞打架 (雙龍搶珠)**
 - 錯誤：He is complain about the game.
 - 正確：He **is complaining** about the game. (be 動詞後面動詞一定要變 V-ing!)
- **✗ 陷阱 3：不可用進行式的「狀態動詞」**
 - 像 doubt (當心智狀態「懷疑」時)、know (知道)、like (喜歡)、want (想要) 等動詞，通常不用進行式！
 - 錯誤：I am knowing your opinion.
 - 正確：I **know** your opinion.

Part 6 : Grammar Practice

A. 動詞 V-ing 變化與 be 動詞填空

1. develop → _____

2. survive → _____
3. decrease → _____
4. complain → _____
5. stop → _____
6. win → _____

B. Choose the best form (現在簡單式 vs 現在進行式)

1. Look at the forum! Many gamers (are complaining / complain) about the update right now.
2. Supercell usually (develops / is developing) mobile games for both iOS and Android.
3. Listen! The game manager (gives / is giving) an important speech in the meeting room.
4. Active player numbers (decrease / are decreasing) quickly at this moment.
5. Jonathan (knows / is knowing) Kevin's honest opinion about the game.
6. The brave team (survives / is surviving) the big crisis right now.

C. CAP-style Contextual Questions

1. *Ryan*: "Where is the engineering team?"
Frank: "They _____ the new horizontal control system in the lab right now."
 A. test B. are testing C. tests D. is testing
2. Look at the numbers on the screen! Player retention _____ rapidly this week!
 A. decrease B. is decreasing C. decreases D. are decreasing
3. *Kevin*: "_____ the company _____ our favorite project?"
Jonathan: "No, they aren't. They are fixing the problems."
 A. Is ; cancel B. Does ; cancel C. Is ; cancelling D. Does ; cancelling
4. Be quiet, please. The team managers _____ the future of the game in that room.
 A. discuss B. is discussing C. are discussing D. discussing

Part 7 : Speaking - The Developer's Meeting

情境設定： 你是 Supercell 的資深遊戲開發者，正在跟專案負責人討論《荒野亂鬥》的危機與轉型。使用現在進行式與本週 800 級單字完成對話：

- **Lead**: "Look at the forum! What are players saying about our game right now?"
- **You (Jonathan)**: "Many players _____ (complain / about / the old vertical screen)."
- **Lead**: "The active player numbers are decreasing fast! What are we doing to save the project?"
- **You (Jonathan)**: "We _____ (develop / a unique two-thumb system) right now!"
- **Lead**: "Is our team working under heavy pressure?"
- **You (Jonathan)**: "Yes, we are! But the game _____ (survive / the crisis) and players are giving positive opinions now!"

Homework : Vocabulary, Pronunciation & Grammar Review

A. Match the words with their meanings

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| 1. develop | A. 存活；挺過（危機） |
| 2. decrease | B. 抱怨；抗議 |
| 3. pressure | C. 獨特的；與眾不同的 |
| 4. complain | D. 減少；下降 |
| 5. unique | E. 開發；研發 |
| 6. survive | F. 壓力 |

B. Choose a word from the box

cancel | doubt | negative | opinion | positive | system

7. When you have _____, talk to your teacher or parents for help.
8. If the team cannot fix the bug, the company will _____ the project.
9. What is your personal _____ of the new Brawl Stars update?
10. The new control _____ makes shooting enemies much easier.
11. Even when early reviews were _____, the team stayed hopeful.
12. With hard work, the team received _____ feedback from millions of new players.

C. Choose the correct answer

13. Look! The player numbers _____ rapidly at the moment.
A. rise B. are rising C. is rising D. rises
14. Jonathan often _____ games with his friends on Sundays, but today he _____ his English homework.
A. plays ; is doing B. is playing ; does C. play ; is doing D. is playing ; is doing
15. "Why are the developers cheering?" "Because their new game _____ the strict test!"
A. survive B. is surviving C. survives D. are surviving
16. Supercell always _____ creative games with high quality standards.
A. produce B. produces C. is producing D. are producing

D. 🎧 Pronunciation Self-Check & Voice Recording Challenge

請對著錄音筆或手機語音備忘錄，朗讀以下 3 個進階句子，確認自己沒有犯台灣人的 4 大發音陷阱：

- ☐ 句子 1 : *The developers had doubt, but they created a unique system.*
(檢查 : **doubt** 的 **b** 有沒有偷發音？字尾 **t** 有沒有煞車？ **unique** 有沒有唸成 you-NEEK？)
- ☐ 句子 2 : *Players shared positive opinions after the update.*
(檢查 : **opinion** 第一音節有沒有弱化成 /ə/？ **positive** 重音有沒有在最前面？)
- ☐ 句子 3 : *The brave team worked under pressure to survive the crisis.*
(檢查 : **survive** 兩個 **v** 上門牙有沒有咬下嘴唇？不能唸成 sur-why-ve！)

E. Short Writing

17. 用現在進行式寫出一個句子，描述你或遊戲團隊「正在努力做的一件事」（使用 **now** 或 **right now**，並盡量用上一個本週 800 級單字）：